

Avionics and Aircraft Electrical Wiring Systems: Standards for Installation, Termination, and Bonding

Aviation Standards Division

May 24, 2026

Document ID: MRO-AW-HB-004

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Chapter 1

Power Distribution & Circuit Protection Standards

Aircraft electrical power distribution architectures are fundamentally bifurcated into alternating current (AC) and direct current (DC) bus networks, designed to deliver highly regulated power to avionics and electromechanical actuators. The primary AC generation system operates at 115V RMS line-to-neutral, 200V line-to-line, three-phase, 400Hz. This specific frequency is selected to minimize the mass and volume of magnetic components, such as transformers and induction motors, while maintaining efficient power transmission. Transformer Rectifier Units (TRUs) step down and rectify the 115VAC to a nominal 28VDC for the DC bus architecture. TRU output must maintain a ripple factor of less than 4% under full continuous load, ensuring that sensitive solid-state avionics are not subjected to destructive harmonic interference or thermal degradation. Load balancing across the three-phase AC buses is continuously monitored by the Bus Power Control Unit (BPCU), which automatically sheds non-essential loads during generator transient overloads to maintain phase symmetry within a 5% tolerance.

Circuit protection within these distribution networks relies on the precise coordination of thermal and thermal-magnetic circuit breakers. Sizing these protective devices requires rigorous analysis of both continuous and intermittent load profiles. For continuous duty applications, defined as operations exceeding three minutes, the circuit breaker must be rated at no less than 125% of the maximum continuous load current to prevent nuisance tripping induced by ambient thermal accumulation. The governing equation for continuous thermal circuit breaker sizing is $I_{rated} \geq I_{continuous}/0.8$. Conversely, intermittent loads, such as actuator motors or landing gear hydraulics, necessitate thermal-magnetic breakers equipped with high-inrush trip delay curves. These magnetic trip elements must be calibrated to withstand inrush currents up to 800% of the nominal rating for a duration of 50 milliseconds without actuating, while still providing instantaneous short-circuit protection. The ambient temperature derating factor must also be applied; for every 10°C increase in the equipment bay ambient temperature above the standard 25°C baseline, the continuous current rating of the thermal breaker must be derated by 5%. Furthermore, all circuit breakers installed in unpressurized or high-altitude zones must be derated for the reduced convective cooling capacity of rarefied air, typically requiring a 15% reduction in nominal current capacity at altitudes exceeding 40,000 feet.

Chapter 2

Aerospace Wire Specification & Ampacity Sizing

The selection of aerospace wire insulation materials is dictated by the competing requirements of dielectric strength, mechanical abrasion resistance, and thermal stability. Historically, Polyimide (Kapton) insulation was utilized for its high-temperature tolerance; however, it exhibits severe vulnerabilities to hydrolysis and arc tracking. When exposed to high humidity and mechanical chafing, Polyimide degrades into a conductive carbonized path, allowing electrical arcs to propagate longitudinally along the wire harness, potentially causing catastrophic in-flight fires. Consequently, modern airworthiness directives mandate the use of Tefzel (Ethylene Tetrafluoroethylene, ETFE) or cross-linked ETFE (XL-ETFE) for general airframe wiring. XL-ETFE provides superior cut-through resistance and maintains dielectric integrity up to 200°C, effectively mitigating arc tracking phenomena while reducing overall harness mass by approximately 15% compared to legacy fluoropolymer insulations.

Ampacity sizing and voltage drop calculations are critical to ensuring terminal equipment receives adequate operating voltage. The American Wire Gauge (AWG) standard dictates the cross-sectional area and corresponding DC resistance per unit length. The maximum allowable voltage drop on critical avionics buses is strictly limited to 2% of the nominal bus voltage, equating to a maximum drop of 0.56V on a 28VDC system. The voltage drop ΔV for a single-phase or DC circuit is calculated using the formula $\Delta V = \frac{2 \cdot \rho \cdot L \cdot I}{A}$, where ρ is the resistivity of the conductor material (typically copper or aluminum), L is the one-way length of the wire, I is the continuous load current, and A is the cross-sectional area. For three-phase AC systems, the multiplier 2 is replaced by $\sqrt{3}$ to account for the phase geometry. Wire ampacity must be further derated based on the number of current-carrying conductors bundled within a single harness. According to SAE AS50881, a bundle containing 10 to 20 conductors requires a 30% derating of the single-wire free-air ampacity to compensate for the trapped thermal mass and reduced convective cooling. Aluminum conductors, while offering a 40% weight reduction compared to copper, possess a higher resistivity and are strictly prohibited in applications subject to high vibration or frequent flexing due to their susceptibility to work hardening and subsequent fatigue fracture.

Table 2.1: AWG Resistance and Ampacity Profiles (Single Wire, Free Air, 200°C Rated XL-ETFE)

AWG Size	Stranding	Max Resistance (Ω /1000ft @ 20°C)	Rated Ampacity (A)
22	19/34	16.14	5.0
20	19/32	9.95	7.5
18	19/30	6.39	10.0
16	19/29	4.02	13.0
14	19/27	2.52	17.0
12	37/28	1.59	23.0
10	37/26	0.99	33.0

Chapter 3

Harness Routing, Clamping, and Separation Standards

Physical routing of electrical harnesses requires strict adherence to spatial separation matrices to prevent mechanical interference, thermal degradation, and fluid contamination. Harnesses must maintain a minimum stand-off clearance of 3/8 inch (9.5 mm) from primary airframe structures, bulkheads, and skin panels to prevent chafing induced by airframe torsional flexing and acoustic vibration. When routing parallel to mechanical flight control cables, push-pull tubes, or hydraulic lines, a minimum lateral separation of 2 inches (50.8 mm) is mandated. This separation prevents electrical arcing from compromising flight-critical mechanical systems in the event of a harness short circuit. Furthermore, electrical harnesses must never be routed below fluid-carrying lines (fuel, hydraulic, or oxygen) to prevent catastrophic insulation degradation from fluid drips. If crossing a fluid line is unavoidable, the electrical harness must be routed above the fluid line with a minimum vertical clearance of 6 inches, and a drip shield or physical barrier must be installed.

Bundle clamping intervals and hardware selection are dictated by the bundle diameter and the environmental zone. MS21919 series cushion clamps are the standard for securing harnesses to the airframe. The spacing between clamps must not exceed 18 inches for horizontal runs and 12 inches for vertical runs to prevent gravitational sagging and resonant vibration. The cushion material of the clamp must be selected based on the environmental exposure: silicone cushions are utilized for general airframe zones, whereas fluorosilicone or ethylene-propylene diene monomer (EPDM) cushions are strictly required in areas exposed to hydrocarbon fuels, synthetic hydraulic fluids (such as Skydrol), or de-icing chemicals, as standard silicone rapidly degrades and swells when exposed to these agents. Clamps must be sized such that the harness occupies at least 75% of the clamp's inner diameter to prevent longitudinal migration, but must not be over-tightened to the point of deforming the wire insulation. The fastening torque for the clamp mounting hardware must strictly adhere to the values specified in the airframe structural manual, typically utilizing self-locking nuts with a prevailing torque of 10 to 15 inch-pounds to ensure retention under high-G maneuver loads.

Chapter 4

Mechanical Strain Relief & Bend Radii Calculations

The mechanical integrity of aerospace wiring is highly dependent on the strict enforcement of minimum bend radii, which prevents excessive tensile stress on the outer conductor strands and compressive deformation of the inner insulation. Exceeding the minimum bend radius induces work hardening in the copper stranding, leading to micro-fractures that increase electrical resistance and create localized thermal hotspots. For standard multi-conductor wire bundles, the minimum bend radius R_{min} is calculated as a function of the bundle's outer diameter D_{bundle} , defined by the relationship $R_{min} = 10 \cdot D_{bundle}$. This 10-to-1 ratio ensures that the tensile strain on the outermost wires of the bundle remains within the elastic limit of the copper alloy. For single, un-bundled wires, the minimum bend radius is reduced to $R_{min} = 3 \cdot D_{wire}$, where D_{wire} is the outer diameter of the individual insulated conductor.

High-frequency coaxial cables and shielded data buses require significantly more stringent bend radius limits to preserve their electromagnetic geometry. The minimum bend radius for coaxial lines is strictly defined as $R_{min} = 6 \cdot D_{coax}$. Bending a coaxial cable tighter than this threshold displaces the center conductor relative to the outer shielding braid, altering the characteristic impedance of the transmission line and causing signal reflections that degrade high-frequency data integrity. In addition to bend radii, mechanical strain relief must be implemented at all terminal connections. A service loop, or drip loop, of sufficient length must be provided at connector backshells to absorb mechanical shock and thermal expansion differentials. The strain relief must ensure that no tensile load is transferred directly to the crimp barrel or the solder cup. For potted connectors, the potting compound must extend at least 0.25 inches into the connector insert to encapsulate the wire insulation and provide a rigid mechanical transition zone, effectively distributing any applied bending moments over a broader cross-sectional area rather than concentrating stress at the crimp junction.

Chapter 5

Terminal Lug & Splice Crimping SOPs

Crimping is the primary method for terminating aerospace wiring, providing a gas-tight, cold-welded mechanical and electrical junction that outperforms soldering in high-vibration and high-thermal-cycling environments. The crimping process requires the use of precision pneumatic or manual indent crimp tools, specifically the M22520 series, which are calibrated to apply exact radial compression forces to the crimp barrel. The selection of the tool, turret head, and positioner is strictly dictated by the contact size and wire gauge. Before crimping, the wire insulation must be stripped to a precise length, exposing the conductor strands without nicking, cutting, or scraping the outer layer of strands. The strip length tolerance is typically ± 0.015 inches. The exposed strands must exhibit a uniform lay angle and show no signs of unraveling or bird-caging; if the strands are disturbed, they must be gently retwisted to their original factory lay angle to ensure proper insertion into the crimp barrel.

Following the crimp operation, the termination must undergo rigorous visual and mechanical inspection. Visually, the wire strands must be flush with or extend slightly (maximum 0.031 inches) beyond the front of the crimp barrel, confirming full insertion depth. The insulation must be positioned exactly at the insulation grip section of the barrel, with no copper exposed between the insulation grip and the wire crimp section. Mechanically, the integrity of the crimp is verified through destructive pull-testing of sample coupons prepared from the same batch of materials and tooling settings. The tensile pull-test values establish the minimum axial force required to separate the wire from the terminal without the crimp failing.

Table 5.1: Minimum Mechanical Pull-Test Tensile Values for Indent Crimps

Wire Size (AWG)	Contact Size	Minimum Pull Force (lbf)
22	22D	8.0
20	20	15.0
18	20	20.0
16	16	30.0
14	16	40.0
12	12	60.0
10	12	85.0

Chapter 6

High-Frequency Coaxial Terminations (RF Systems)

High-frequency radio frequency (RF) systems, including VHF communications, transponders, and weather radar, rely on coaxial transmission lines to route signals with minimal attenuation and phase distortion. The termination of these cables utilizing BNC, TNC, and N-type connectors requires extreme precision to maintain the 50-ohm or 75-ohm characteristic impedance of the line. The assembly procedure begins with the precise stripping of the coaxial cable using dedicated stepped stripping tools that remove the outer jacket, braid shield, and dielectric layer to exact dimensional tolerances without scoring the center conductor. Scoring the center conductor creates a stress riser that will inevitably lead to fatigue failure under vibration, while leaving dielectric residue on the conductor compromises the solder joint integrity.

The shielding braid must be carefully folded back and secured using the connector's ferrule or crimp sleeve, ensuring 360-degree circumferential contact to prevent RF leakage and maintain the shield's transfer impedance. The center conductor is then soldered to the connector's center pin using rosin-core, high-purity tin-lead or lead-free aerospace solder, ensuring a smooth, concave fillet without cold solder joints or excessive solder bridging. Impedance matching is critical; a 50-ohm system utilized for communications and radar must never be mated with 75-ohm components intended for video or cabin entertainment systems, as the impedance mismatch generates signal reflections. The quality of the termination is quantitatively verified using a Time Domain Reflectometer (TDR) or a Vector Network Analyzer (VNA) to measure the Voltage Standing Wave Ratio (VSWR). The VSWR is calculated as $VSWR = \frac{1+|\Gamma|}{1-|\Gamma|}$, where Γ is the reflection coefficient. For airworthiness compliance, the VSWR across the operational frequency band of the assembled coaxial run must not exceed 1.5:1, indicating that less than 4% of the transmitted power is being reflected back to the source due to impedance discontinuities at the terminations.

Chapter 7

Electromagnetic Interference (EMI) Mitigation & Shielding

Electromagnetic Interference (EMI) poses a severe threat to the integrity of digital avionics data buses and sensitive analog sensor signals. Mitigation is achieved through the implementation of twisted shielded pair (TSP) or twisted shielded quad (TSQ) cable configurations, combined with rigorous shielding and grounding practices. The twisting of the signal conductors ensures that any externally induced magnetic flux couples equally into both wires, generating common-mode noise that is subsequently rejected by the differential receivers at the avionics interface. The metallic shield surrounding the twisted pair provides a Faraday cage effect, attenuating high-frequency electric field interference. The effectiveness of this shield is quantified by its transfer impedance Z_t , which must remain below 100 milliohms per meter at frequencies up to 100 MHz for critical flight control data buses such as ARINC 429 or MIL-STD-1553.

Shield grounding practices dictate the use of single-point grounding for low-frequency analog signals to prevent the formation of ground loops, which occur when multiple ground paths with differing electrical potentials allow circulating currents to flow through the shield, thereby injecting noise into the signal conductors. Conversely, high-frequency digital data buses and RF systems require multi-point grounding, where the shield is bonded to the airframe structure at both ends and at intermediate intervals, to provide a low-impedance return path for high-frequency noise currents. The termination of the shield to the connector backshell must utilize a 360-degree circumferential crimp or banding mechanism. The legacy practice of "pigtail" grounding, where the shield braid is gathered and terminated via a single wire, is strictly prohibited for frequencies above 1 MHz, as the inductance of the pigtail wire severely degrades the shield's high-frequency effectiveness, effectively rendering the shield transparent to EMI. Furthermore, EMI isolation distances mandate that unshielded or low-level signal wires maintain a minimum separation of 6 inches from high-current AC power feeds and ignition harnesses.

Chapter 8

Structural Bonding & Ground Stud Resistance Standards

Structural bonding is the process of establishing a low-impedance electrical path between aircraft components and the primary airframe structure, serving three critical functions: providing a return path for electrical power, ensuring electrostatic discharge (ESD) dissipation, and establishing a conductive network for lightning strike protection. Surface preparation is the most critical phase of the bonding process. All paint, primer, sealant, and anodized layers must be completely removed from the bonding interface using abrasive blasting, Scotch-Brite pads, or chemical stripping, exposing the bare base metal. For aluminum structures, the exposed surface must immediately be treated with a chemical conversion coating, such as Alodine 1201 or Alodine 1200S, to inhibit oxidation and provide a stable, low-resistance contact surface. The conversion coating must be allowed to cure fully before the installation of the bonding jumper or ground stud.

The mechanical fastening of ground studs and bonding jumpers requires the application of precise torque values to ensure adequate contact pressure without yielding the fastener or the airframe structure. Self-locking nuts or lock washers are mandatory to maintain this pressure under vibrational loads. The electrical efficacy of the bond is quantitatively verified using a 4-wire Kelvin micro-ohmmeter, which eliminates the measurement error introduced by the resistance of the test leads. The maximum allowable bonding resistance thresholds are strictly defined by the system's function. For standard electrical power returns and equipment grounding (Class R bonds), the resistance must not exceed 2.5 milliohms. For static discharge wicks and lightning strike current paths (Class C bonds), where the structure must safely conduct tens of thousands of amperes without localized melting, the resistance threshold is tightened to a maximum of 1.5 milliohms. Any bond exceeding these limits must be disassembled, re-prepared, and re-tested until compliance is achieved.

Chapter 9

Avionics Tray Structural Rigging & Cooling Plenums

Avionics equipment is predominantly housed in standardized Air Transport Rack (ATR) enclosures, governed by ARINC 600 specifications, which provide structural support, electrical interconnection, and environmental cooling. The installation and rigging of these avionics trays require meticulous attention to mechanical alignment and shock isolation. The trays are secured to the aircraft floor or bulkhead using shock mounts designed to attenuate high-frequency vibration and survive high-G crash impact loads. These shock mounts must be inspected for elastomeric degradation, cracking, or permanent set deformation. The mounting hardware must utilize self-locking fasteners torqued to the precise structural limits to prevent tray migration, which could shear the rear connector backshells or misalign the forced-air cooling plenums.

Thermal management within the avionics bay is critical, as solid-state components experience an exponential increase in failure rates for every 10°C rise in junction temperature. Cooling is achieved via forced-air blowers or convection loops integrated into the tray structure. The thermal dissipation capacity of the cooling system must be calculated to ensure the internal ambient temperature remains below the equipment's rated maximum, typically 55°C or 70°C. The heat transfer equation $Q = \dot{m}c_p\Delta T$ is utilized, where Q is the heat load in watts, $\dot{m}$ is the mass flow rate of the cooling air, c_p is the specific heat capacity of air, and ΔT is the allowable temperature rise across the avionics line-replaceable unit (LRU). The cooling plenums must be sealed with fire-resistant, high-temperature silicone gaskets to prevent air leakage, ensuring that the forced air is directed precisely through the LRU heat exchangers rather than bypassing the equipment. Regular maintenance requires the inspection and replacement of inlet particulate filters to maintain the designed mass flow rate and prevent thermal throttling of the avionics.

Chapter 10

Instrument Connector Pin Insertion & Extraction

The termination of complex avionics harnesses relies on high-density circular and rectangular connectors utilizing removable crimp contacts. The insertion and extraction of these pins demand the use of specialized, color-coded insertion and extraction tools, specifically the M81969/14 series, to prevent catastrophic damage to the connector's internal retention clips and insulator cavities. The tool color is strictly mapped to the contact size to ensure the correct mechanical interface. For size 22D contacts, which accommodate AWG 22 to AWG 28 wire, the required insertion and extraction tools are colored red. For size 20 contacts (AWG 20 to AWG 24), the tools are colored blue. For size 16 contacts (AWG 16 to AWG 20), the tools are colored yellow. Utilizing an incorrectly sized tool will either fail to release the retention tang during extraction, tearing the insulator, or fail to properly seat the contact during insertion, leading to intermittent electrical connections.

Connector keying and polarization mechanisms must be verified prior to mating to prevent cross-wiring or physical damage to the insert. A visual inspection of the service loops inside the connector backshell is mandatory; the wires must possess sufficient slack to absorb thermal expansion and mechanical shock without transferring tensile stress to the crimp joints. During insertion, the technician must apply axial pressure until an audible and tactile "click" confirms that the contact retention tang has engaged the insulator shoulder. Following insertion, a gentle rearward pull on the wire, known as the "tug test," must be performed to verify that the contact is fully locked in the cavity. Extraction requires the tool to be slid over the wire and fully seated against the front face of the contact, applying inward pressure to collapse the retention tangs while simultaneously pulling the wire rearward. If a contact becomes stuck, excessive force must never be applied; instead, the tool must be resealed, and the cavity inspected for debris or deformed tangs.

Chapter 11

Insulation Resistance & Continuity Verification

Verification of the electrical integrity of newly installed or repaired harnesses requires stringent insulation resistance and continuity testing protocols. Insulation resistance testing, commonly referred to as "Megger testing," evaluates the dielectric strength of the wire insulation and the absence of conductive contamination or moisture ingress. The test is conducted using a high-voltage megohmmeter, which applies a controlled DC potential across the insulation barrier. For standard 28VDC and 115VAC avionics wiring, the test voltage is strictly set to 500V DC. Applying a higher voltage, such as 1000V, risks puncturing the thin aerospace insulation layers and causing latent dielectric breakdown. Prior to testing, all solid-state avionics, capacitors, and sensitive electronic components must be physically disconnected or isolated from the harness to prevent catastrophic overvoltage damage.

The 500V DC potential is applied between the conductor and the airframe ground, and between adjacent conductors within the same bundle, for a duration of one minute to allow the capacitive charging current to decay and the dielectric absorption current to stabilize. The minimum acceptable insulation resistance threshold is 100 Megohms ($M\Omega$) per circuit. Readings below this value indicate compromised insulation, moisture contamination, or conductive dust ingress, necessitating immediate troubleshooting and remediation. Following the high-potential test, the circuit must be safely discharged using a grounded discharge stick to prevent electrical shock to the technician. Continuity validation is subsequently performed using a low-voltage digital multimeter to verify point-to-point electrical connectivity, ensuring that the correct pins are terminated to the correct destinations according to the wiring diagram, and that the total circuit resistance falls within the calculated theoretical limits based on the wire gauge and length.

Chapter 12

Electrical Load Analysis (ELA) & Logbook Documentation

Any modification, addition, or alteration to the aircraft's electrical system mandates a comprehensive Electrical Load Analysis (ELA) to verify that the generation and distribution capacities are not exceeded. The ELA categorizes all electrical loads into continuous, intermittent, and emergency profiles. Continuous loads, such as avionics and lighting, are summed and compared against the continuous rating of the generators and TRUs. Intermittent loads, such as flap motors and landing gear actuators, are analyzed for simultaneous operation probabilities to ensure that transient voltage dips do not disrupt critical flight systems. The analysis must demonstrate a minimum load margin of 20% above the calculated maximum continuous load to accommodate future system expansions and account for generator degradation over time. In the event of a single-generator failure, the ELA must prove that the remaining generation capacity, coupled with automated load shedding protocols, can sustain all essential and emergency loads for the duration of the flight.

Compliance verification and documentation are governed by 14 CFR Part 43, which dictates the legal requirements for maintenance, preventive maintenance, and alterations. Upon successful completion of the installation, testing, and ELA verification, the certifying mechanic or inspector must make a detailed entry in the aircraft's permanent maintenance logbook. The logbook entry must explicitly describe the work performed, reference the specific engineering drawings, service bulletins, and Supplemental Type Certificate (STC) data utilized, and state that the aircraft has been inspected and found airworthy. The entry must include the date of completion, the signature, and the certificate number of the authorized individual returning the aircraft to service. Incomplete, ambiguous, or missing logbook documentation renders the aircraft legally unairworthy, regardless of the physical quality of the installation, as it breaks the traceable chain of airworthiness compliance required by aviation regulatory authorities.

Appendix D: Daily Avionics Wiring Maintenance Checklist

This checklist establishes the quantitative bounds and measurements required during daily inspections, wiring routing alterations, and termination processes. All values are sourced from FAA AC 43.13-1B Chapter 11 and SAE AS50881.

Table 12.1: Avionics Wiring Installation and Bonding Specifications

Maintenance Item	Measurement / Range	Regulatory / Tool Ref
Ground Stud Bonding (Class R)	$\leq 2.5 \text{ m}\Omega$	4-Wire Kelvin Micro-ohmmeter
Ground Stud Bonding (Class C)	$\leq 1.5 \text{ m}\Omega$	4-Wire Kelvin Micro-ohmmeter
Static Wick Ground Path	$\leq 10.0 \text{ m}\Omega$	High-voltage Megohmmeter
Harness Stand-off (Airframe)	$\geq 3/8 \text{ inch (9.5 mm)}$	Visual / Steel Ruler
Harness Parallel Separation	$\geq 2.0 \text{ inches (50.8 mm)}$	Separation from Control/Hyd
Harness Crossing (Fluid Line)	$\geq 6.0 \text{ inches (152.4 mm)}$	Routing must cross above fluid
Wire Bundle Bend Radius ($R_{\min}$)	$10 \times D_{\text{bundle}}$	Calibrated Outer Diameter Ch
Single Wire Bend Radius ($R_{\min}$)	$3 \times D_{\text{wire}}$	Calibrated Outer Diameter Ch
Coaxial Cable Bend Radius ($R_{\min}$)	$6 \times D_{\text{coax}}$	BNC/TNC Signal Feedlines
MS21919 Cushion Clamp Spacing	$\leq 18 \text{ inches (Horiz.)}/12 \text{ in (Vert.)}$	Structural support intervals
Clamp Mounting Nut Torque	10 to 15 in-lbs (1.1 to 1.7 Nm)	Calibrated torque wrench
Critical Avionics Voltage Drop	$\leq 2\% \text{ of bus V (0.56V on 28VDC)}$	Digital Multimeter (DMM)
Insulation Resistance (Megger)	$\geq 100 \text{ M}\Omega \text{ at } 500\text{V DC}$	Test time: 1 minute (solid-stat
AWG 22 Crimp Tensile Strength	$\geq 8.0 \text{ lbf}$	Mechanical Pull Tester (M225
AWG 20 Crimp Tensile Strength	$\geq 15.0 \text{ lbf}$	Mechanical Pull Tester (M225
AWG 16 Crimp Tensile Strength	$\geq 30.0 \text{ lbf}$	Mechanical Pull Tester (M225
Voltage Standing Wave Ratio (VSWR)	$\leq 1.5 : 1 \text{ across operational band}$	Time Domain Reflectometer (T

Appendices & References

Appendix A: Acronyms and Glossary

AC: Alternating Current. **ATR:** Air Transport Rack. **AWG:** American Wire Gauge. **BPCU:** Bus Power Control Unit. **CB:** Circuit Breaker. **DC:** Direct Current. **ELA:** Electrical Load Analysis. **EMI:** Electromagnetic Interference. **ESD:** Electrostatic Discharge. **ETFE:** Ethylene Tetrafluoroethylene. **LRU:** Line-Replaceable Unit. **STC:** Supplemental Type Certificate. **TRU:** Transformer Rectifier Unit. **TSP:** Twisted Shielded Pair. **VNA:** Vector Network Analyzer. **VSWR:** Voltage Standing Wave Ratio.

Appendix B: Troubleshooting Matrix

Symptom	Probable Cause	Corrective Action
Nuisance CB Tripping	Ambient thermal accumulation or inrush current	Verify continuous load derating; upgrade to thermal-magnetic CB with high-inrush delay.
High VSWR on RF line	Coaxial bend radius violation or center conductor scoring	Inspect routing for $< 6 \times D$ bends; replace damaged coaxial segment and re-terminate.
Insulation Resistance $< 100M\Omega$	Moisture ingress, chafing, or conductive contamination	Isolate circuit, perform visual inspection of harness routing, clean connectors, apply moisture sealant.
Bonding Resistance $> 2.5m\Omega$	Inadequate surface prep, paint intrusion, or loose hardware	Disassemble bond, strip to bare metal, apply Alodine 1201, re-torque to specification.

Appendix C: Formal Bibliography

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